

English Literature

Middletown High School | Grade 12, Fall Semester 2026

Teacher: Mr. J. Abernathy
Room: 305
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Course Description

A literature and composition course. Students read short fiction, poetry, drama and a modern novel, and write analytical essays that make an argument and support it with text.

Course Units

Weeks 1 to 3	Unit 1: Short Stories Narrative structure, point of view, characterization and theme in American and world short fiction.
Weeks 4 to 6	Unit 2: Poetry Analysis Imagery, metaphor, simile, personification and alliteration. Featured poets include Langston Hughes, Emily Dickinson and Sylvia Plath.
Weeks 7 to 10	Unit 3: Shakespeare, Macbeth Close reading of the play. Act 1 Scene 7 is the soliloquy where Macbeth weighs murdering King Duncan. Themes are ambition, guilt, and fate against free will.
Weeks 11 to 13	Unit 4: Modern Fiction One full length novel with attention to voice, structure and historical context.
Weeks 14 to 16	Unit 5: Essay Writing Thesis construction, evidence selection, counterargument and revision.

Key Dates This Semester

Sep 29	Poetry Essay due
Oct 26	Macbeth Scene Analysis due
Nov 17	Book Report due
Dec 16	Final Exam

School wide dates

Sep 8	First day of classes
Oct 19 to Oct 23	Mid-term examination week
Nov 6	Parent teacher conferences
Nov 25 to Nov 27	Thanksgiving break, no classes
Dec 14 to Dec 18	Final examination week

Materials

Class texts (provided), composition notebook, highlighters, access to a word processor.

Grading Policy

35 percent	Essays and writing
15 percent	Class participation
15 percent	Reading quizzes
15 percent	Unit tests
20 percent	Final exam

A = 90 to 100 percent, B = 80 to 89, C = 70 to 79, D = 60 to 69, F = 59 and below.

Late and Make-Up Work

Work handed in late without an excused absence receives a maximum of 50 percent credit. With an excused absence, work is due within one week of returning. It is the student's responsibility to ask what was missed. Make-up tests are held on Thursdays after school and must be booked at least one day ahead.

Academic Honesty

All work submitted must be your own. Copying another student's work, or submitting text or code generated by someone or something else as your own, is treated as academic dishonesty and results in a zero for that assignment and a call home.

Extra Help

Extra help is available Tuesdays and Thursdays, 3:15 to 4:00 pm, in the room listed above.